LESSON 4

Ode to Joy

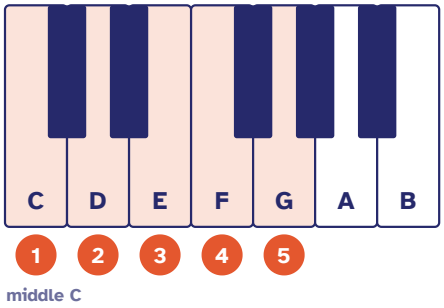
A tune from Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, first played in Vienna in 1824. The words here are our own.

IN THIS SONG **the staff** **the Queen's sign** **five fingers: C to G** **4/4**

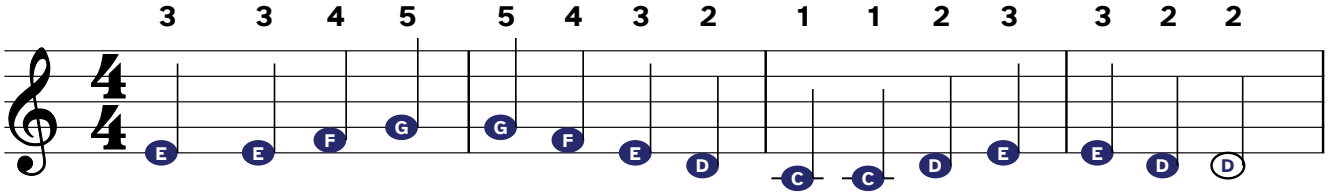
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

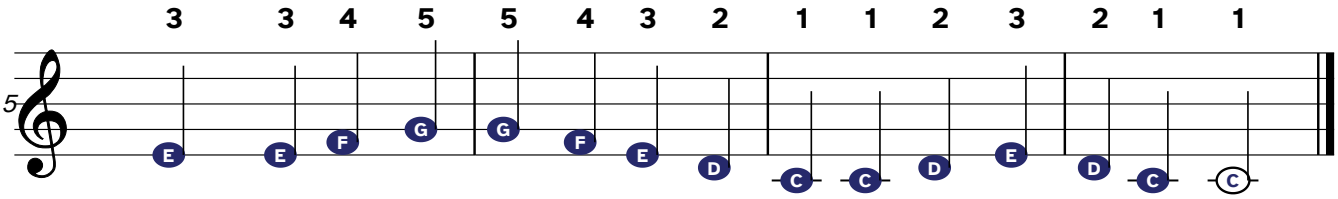
1 Listen and sing

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words, then on the letter names.



Your hand: the C position. Thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G: all five.
The staff arrives. Five lines, and the Queen's sign at the start: her curl wraps round line 2, the note G. The letters still sit inside the notes.





☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Sang it with the words ☐ Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

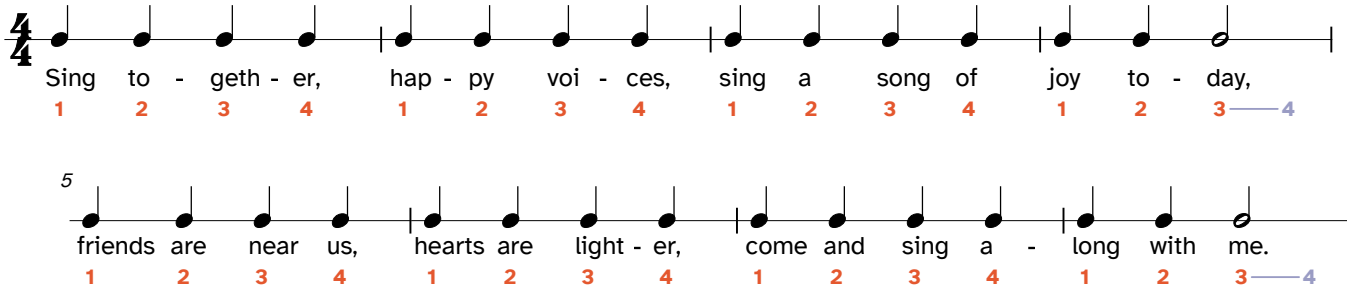
Top 4: four beats in every bar.

Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

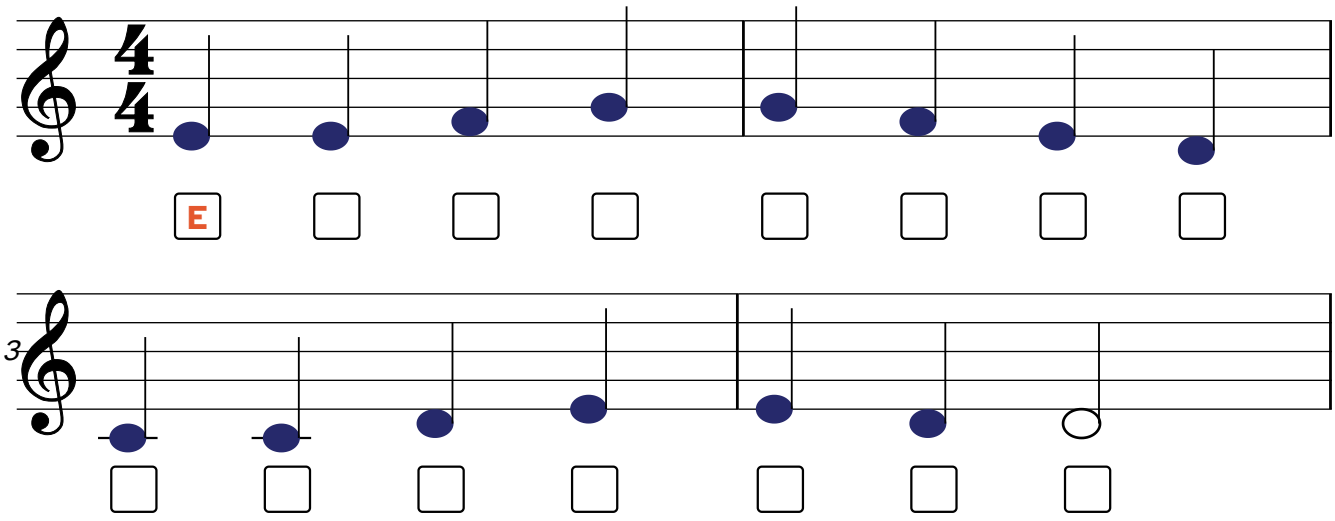
crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●



THE NOTES

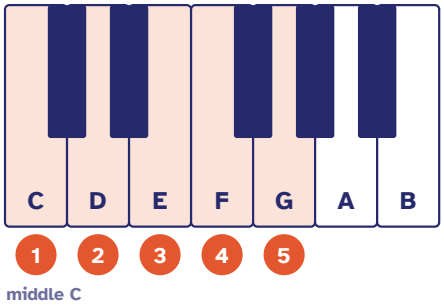
On the staff now: write the letter name under each note of the first four bars. E sits on the bottom line; G on line 2.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Found E and G on their lines**

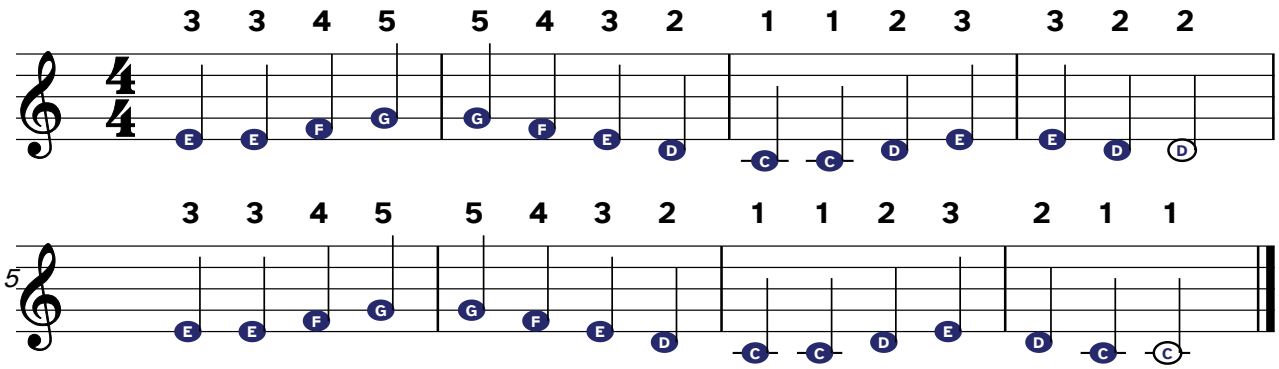
3 Play it

All five fingers in the C position: the right hand, then the left.

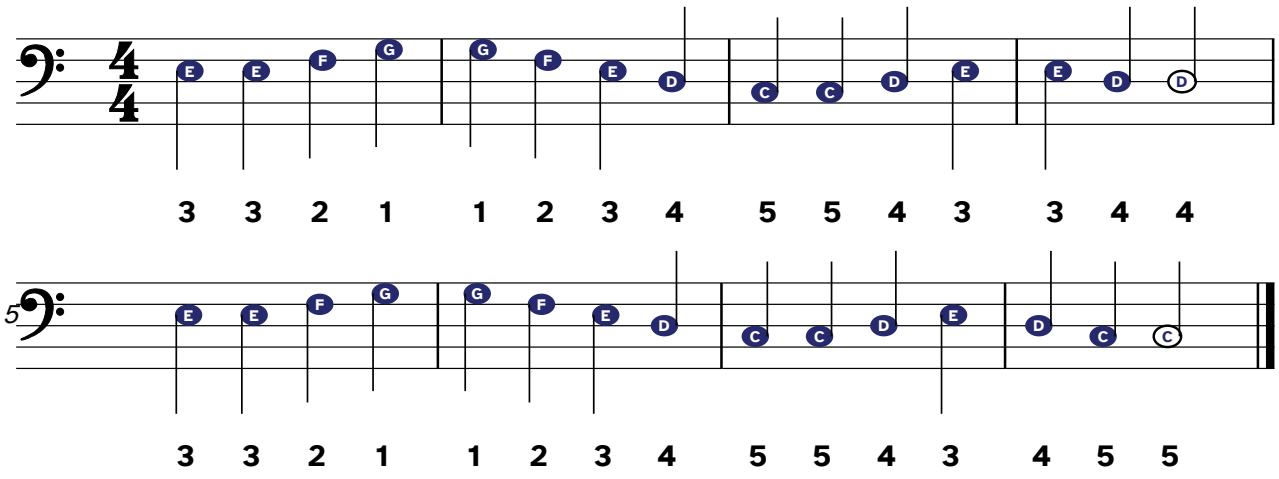


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 2 3 4 5 up to G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, on the King's staff: his sign's two dots wrap round F. Thumb on G, down to 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND the C position



L LEFT HAND the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find E and G on the staff

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

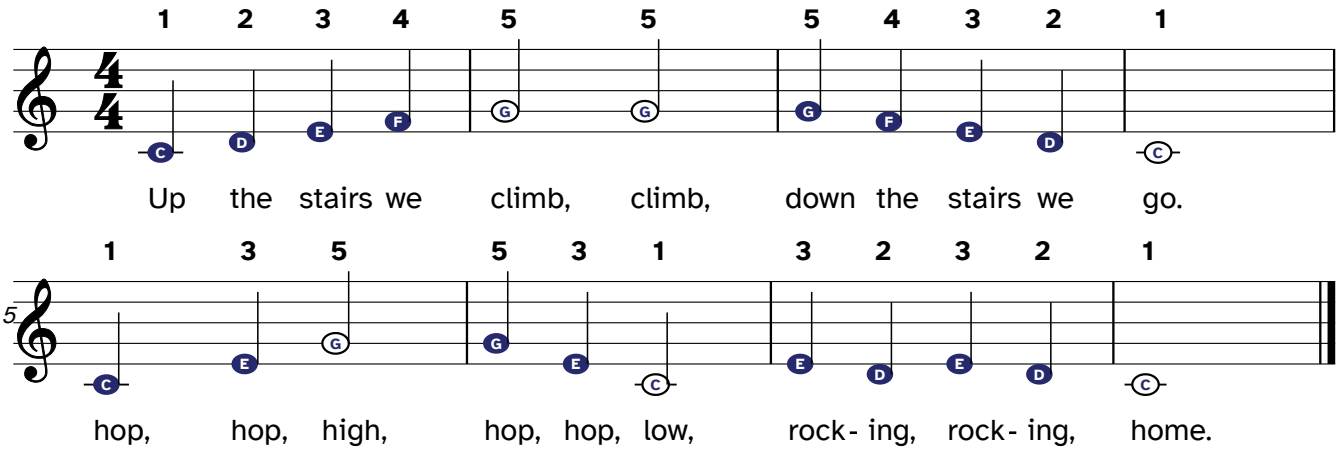
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

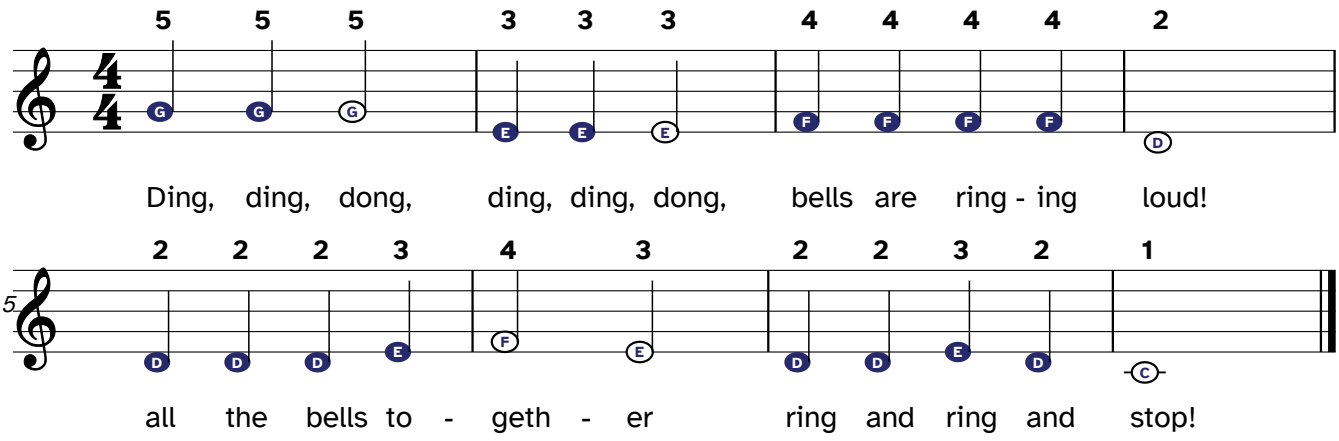
UP AND DOWN THE STAIRS

All five fingers on the staff: steps up, steps down, then hops (skips).



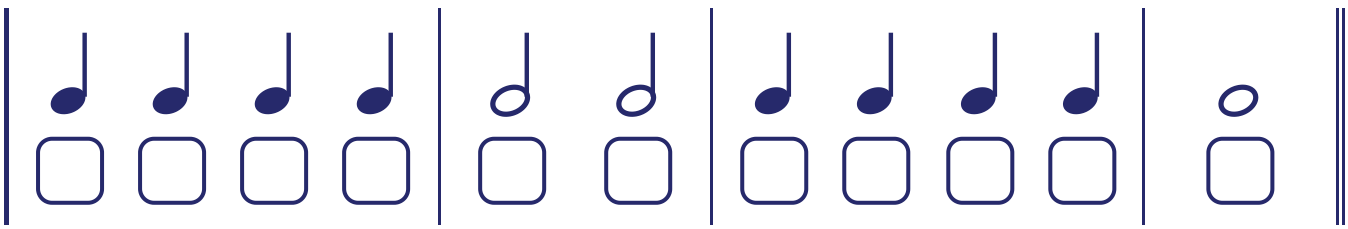
RING THE BELLS

A peek at Lesson 5: the same note again and again, then long notes to hold.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name:



☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune** ☐ **Played my own tune**